



Questions to Ask at an Open Evening

Five mornings of registration in the weeks before sixth form and college open evenings, each one a different kind of question to ask when you get there: about the course, about the day, about the people, about money and getting there, and about what happens if it goes wrong. Each morning the form adds questions of its own, and by the end of the week every student has a printed sheet of questions to take with them. It turns an open evening from a walk round with a parent into a conversation the student is running.

Before you start. Not every student will be going to an open evening, and for some the question of what comes next is a difficult one at home. The activity is about asking, not about where anybody is going, and nobody is asked to say which evenings they are attending. The sheet works for a college, a sixth form, an apprenticeship provider or an employer.

Print these

Page	What it is	How many
Pages 2 and 3	The question sheet, both sides	One per student, printed double-sided if you can

The five mornings

Morning	What happens	Slide
Monday	Hand out the sheets. Show the three questions about the course, then ask the form for more. Two or three go on the board, and students copy the ones they want onto the sheet.	2
Tuesday	The day: hours, free periods, start and finish. Same shape.	3
Wednesday	The people: who to go to, class sizes, whether outsiders settle. Same shape.	4
Thursday	Money and getting there: costs, bursaries, the journey. Same shape.	5
Friday	If it goes wrong: changing course, deadlines, support if grades slip. Then the sheet goes in the bag.	6
After	The Monday after the open evening: which question got the most useful answer, and which one nobody answered.	7

Worth knowing

- The form's own questions are usually better than the printed ones. Leave time for them.
- Run it in any week before the open evenings start. Some schools put the first ones in late September.
- A student who is not going anywhere still asks the questions of the school they are in. Most of them work.

New resources go up on thepastoralguide.com as they are made. Leave your email there and you will hear when they do.





Questions to ask

Tick a question when it has been answered, and write the answer under it. There is a line in each section for one of your own.

About the course

☐

How is it assessed: exams, coursework, or both?

☐

What did last year's students go on to do?

☐

What does a normal week of this course look like?

☐

One of your own:

About the day

☐

How many hours a week am I in lessons, and what happens in the gaps?

☐

Where do students go when they have a free period?

☐

What time does the day start and finish?

☐

One of your own:

About the people

☐

Who would I go to if I was struggling?

☐

How many people are usually in a class?

☐

Do students who did not come from this school settle in?

☐

One of your own:





Questions to ask

The last two kinds of question, and space at the bottom for anything you noticed that nobody told you.

About money and getting there

☐

Is there any cost for trips, books or equipment?

☐

Is there a bursary or any help with costs, and how do I apply?

☐

How do most students get here in the morning?

☐

One of your own:

If it goes wrong

☐

What happens if I pick the wrong subject in the first term?

☐

Can I change courses, and until when?

☐

What support is there if my grades are not what I hoped?

☐

One of your own:

Something I noticed that nobody told me

